THE NIGHT MAIL

Night Mail: Numbered Full Poem 📜🚂

1. This is the night mail crossing the Border,
2. Bringing the cheque and the postal order,
3. Letters for the rich, letters for the poor,
4. The shop at the corner, the girl next door.
5. Pulling up Beattock, a steady climb:
6. The gradient's against her, but she's on time.
7. Past cotton-grass and moorland boulder
8. Shovelling white steam over her shoulder,
9. Snorting noisily as she passes
10. Silent miles of wind-bent grasses.
11. Birds turn their heads as she approaches,
12. Stare from bushes at her blank-faced coaches.
13. Sheep-dogs cannot turn her course;
14. They slumber on with paws across.
15. In the farm she passes no one wakes,
16. But a jug in a bedroom gently shakes.
17. Dawn freshens, Her climb is done.
18. Down towards Glasgow she descends,
19. Towards the steam tugs yelping down a glade of cranes
20. Towards the fields of apparatus, the furnaces
21. Set on the dark plain like gigantic chessmen.
22. All Scotland waits for her:
23. In dark glens, beside pale-green lochs
24. Men long for news.

25.Letters of thanks, letters from banks,

26.Letters of joy from girl and boy,

27.Receipted bills and invitations

28.To inspect new stock or to visit relations,

29.And applications for situations,

30.And timid lovers' declarations,

31. And gossip, gossip from all the nations,

32.News circumstantial, news financial,

33.Letters with holiday snaps to enlarge in,

34.Letters with faces scrawled on the margin,

35.Letters from uncles, cousins, and aunts,

36.Letters to Scotland from the South of France,

37.Letters of condolence to Highlands and Lowlands

38.Written on paper of every hue,

39.The pink, the violet, the white and the blue,

40.The chatty, the catty, the boring, the adoring,

41. The cold and official and the heart's outpouring,

42.Clever, stupid, short and long,

43.The typed and the printed and the spelt all wrong.

44.Thousands are still asleep,

45.Dreaming of terrifying monsters

46.Or of friendly tea beside the band in Cranston's or Crawford's:

47.Asleep in working Glasgow, asleep in well-set Edinburgh,

48.Asleep in granite Aberdeen,

49.They continue their dreams,

50.But shall wake soon and hope for letters,

51. And none will hear the postman's knock

52.Without a quickening of the heart,

53.For who can bear to feel himself forgotten?

Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 1-10) 📖🚂

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Night Mail	A specialized postal train	A train that travels through the night to deliver letters. 🌙
Border	Boundary line	The geographical line between England and Scotland. 🏴 □□□□□□
Cheque	Bank payment paper	Used for large business payments. 💸
Postal Order	Money document	Used by regular people to send small amounts of money. 📄
Beattock	A steep hill/summit	A famous difficult climb for steam trains in Scotland. ⛰️
Steady	Constant / Regular	Moving at a fixed pace without stopping or slowing. 🏃

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Gradient	Slope / Steepness	The angle of the hill the train is fighting against. 📉
Cotton-grass	A white fluffy plant	Soft, wild plants found in the damp Scottish moors. 🌾
Moorland	Open, wild land	High, windy, and empty countryside with no trees. 🏔️
Boulder	A massive rock	Large, ancient stones found in the mountain landscape. 🪨
Snorting	Forceful breathing	The explosive sound of steam leaving the engine. 😤

Line-by-Line Breakdown (Lines 1-10) 🧩✉️

Line 1: This is the night mail crossing the Border,

- **Phrase 1: "This is the night mail"** – Identifying the specific train whose only job is to carry letters while everyone sleeps. 🌑
- **Phrase 2: "crossing the Border"** – The exact moment the train moves from England into the country of Scotland. 🏴□□□□□□
- **Literal Meaning:** The poem starts at the exact moment the specialized postal train reaches the boundary line between England and Scotland. It is late at night, and while the rest of the country is completely silent and asleep, this heavy machine is wide awake and working. It marks a major transition in the journey, moving from the flatter lands of the south into

the much more rugged and hilly territory of the north. The train is a reliable servant of the public that ignores darkness and geography to deliver messages. 🏞️🗺️

- **Imagery:** A lone, dark train with glowing windows cutting through the thick midnight fog. The "Border" acts as a gateway into a wilder, more mysterious landscape. 🌌✨
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the unstoppable progress of duty and the connection between different nations. 🕰️

Line 2: Bringing the cheque and the postal order,

- **Phrase 1: "Bringing the cheque"** – Carrying high-value business payments for banks and companies. 💰
- **Phrase 2: "and the postal order"** – Carrying smaller money transfers for regular families and individuals. 📄
- **Literal Meaning:** The train is acting as a moving financial heart for the entire country. Inside its heavy metal cars, it carries the documents that allow the economy to function. It carries "cheques" which represent big business deals and the wealth of companies, and it carries "postal orders," which were the 1930s method for regular people to send small amounts of money to their relatives. Without this train, the financial connection between people and businesses across hundreds of miles would completely break down. It shows the train's vital role in the survival of the nation. 🏦💼
- **Imagery:** Thousands of bags filled with paper that represent the life savings, debts, and hopes of millions of people. It is an image of "paper power" hidden inside an industrial machine. 📐📈
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the train’s heavy responsibility as a servant to the nation’s economy. ⚖️

Line 3: Letters for the rich, letters for the poor,

- **Phrase 1: "Letters for the rich"** – Mail meant for wealthy people in grand mansions or offices. 🎩🏰
- **Phrase 2: "letters for the poor"** – Mail meant for laborers and families in small, humble houses. 🛠️🏘️
- **Literal Meaning:** The poet explains that the postal service is completely fair and treats every citizen as an equal. The Night Mail does not care about social status or money. It carries the expensive, formal business letters of the upper class alongside the simple, handwritten notes of the poorest citizens. Whether the destination is a palace or a tiny apartment, the train delivers the mail with the same speed and mechanical efficiency. It is the one thing in society that bridges the gap between different social worlds. 🤝🌍
- **Imagery:** A strong visual contrast between mailbags being sorted for grand stone estates and crowded city streets. It creates a picture of a giant "web" of paper touching every type of door in Britain. 🎨🏘️
- **Deep Meaning:** Symbolizes social equality and the universal human need for connection. ⚖️📜

Line 4: The shop at the corner, the girl next door.

- **Phrase 1: "The shop at the corner"** – Connecting small local businesses to the rest of the world. 🏪
- **Phrase 2: "the girl next door"** – Connecting private individuals and their personal secrets or news. 👧
- **Literal Meaning:** The train's mission is not just for the government or the wealthy; it reaches the smallest and most personal parts of everyday life. It brings invoices and orders to the small local shopkeeper who is trying to survive in a neighborhood. At the same time, it carries personal messages, family news, or even a love letter to a regular young woman living on an ordinary street. The train is the link that connects a massive, cold industrial machine to the quiet, private hearts of people in small communities. 🏘️💌

- **Imagery:** Very "homely" and warm imagery. The corner shop and the girl next door are images that everyone recognizes and feels comfortable with. This makes the giant steam engine feel friendly and helpful. 🏠😊
- **Deep Meaning:** Emphasizes that technology exists to serve the most intimate human connections. 💞

Line 5: Pulling up Beattock, a steady climb:

- **Phrase 1: "Pulling up Beattock"** – The engine working at its hardest to go up a famous, steep hill in Scotland. 🏔️
- **Phrase 2: "a steady climb"** – A very difficult but constant and rhythmic movement upward. 🧗
- **Literal Meaning:** The train has reached the most challenging physical part of its journey—the Beattock Summit. This is a very steep section of track where the land is no longer flat, and the train must fight against gravity. The engine has to use its maximum steam and power to pull the heavy weight of the mail bags up the hill. The word "steady" is important because it shows that even though the hill is steep and the work is hard, the train never pauses or gives up; it keeps a rhythmic, determined pace. 🚂💨
- **Imagery:** Intense mechanical effort. You can imagine the glowing orange fire in the engine and the wheels straining against the steel tracks. The rhythm of the words mimics the slow, heavy "thump-thump" of a steam engine under pressure. 🦾⚙️
- **Deep Meaning:** A metaphor for endurance and staying determined through life's hardships. 🧗

Line 6: The gradient's against her, but she's on time.

- **Phrase 1: "The gradient's against her"** – The steepness of the hill is trying to stop or slow the train. 📉🚫
- **Phrase 2: "but she's on time"** – Despite the struggle, the train is exactly on schedule. ⏱️✅

- **Literal Meaning:** This is a battle between nature (the mountain) and human invention (the train). The "gradient" represents the natural obstacle that is trying to make the train fail. However, the train is incredibly reliable and remains "on time," which is the highest honor for a railway. It shows that human discipline and mechanical power are strong enough to overcome natural barriers. The train does not use the steep hills as an excuse for being late; it works twice as hard to keep its promise. 🏆
- **Imagery:** Auden personifies the train as "her." This creates the image of a brave, hardworking woman who is determined to finish her job. It suggests a dramatic race against the clock in the middle of a wild, dark landscape. ⏱️🚂
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents reliability and the victory of human technology over natural obstacles. 🏅

Line 7: Past cotton-grass and moorland boulder

- **Phrase 1: "Past cotton-grass"** – Passing fields of white, fluffy wild plants in the wetlands. 🌾⚪
- **Phrase 2: "and moorland boulder"** – Passing large, ancient, heavy rocks on the hills. 🪨
- **Literal Meaning:** The train is now traveling through a completely empty and wild part of the Scottish countryside. There are no houses or people here—only nature. The "cotton-grass" shows that the land is boggy and soft, while the "boulders" show that it is also harsh and rocky. The train is a modern intruder moving through a landscape that has existed for thousands of years. It highlights how the tracks cut through a world that is raw, quiet, and untouched by human cities. 🏞️🪨
- **Imagery:** A beautiful visual contrast of textures. The soft, fluffy white grass blowing in the wind next to the hard, grey, immovable rocks. The train is a fast visitor in a world where everything else stays perfectly still for centuries. 🎨⛰️

- **Deep Meaning:** Contrasts the moving machine with the permanent, ancient world of nature. 🪨⛰️

Line 8: Shovelling white steam over her shoulder,

- **Phrase 1: "Shovelling white steam"** – Exhausting thick clouds of vapor with massive physical force. ☁️🦾
- **Phrase 2: "over her shoulder"** – The steam trails behind the train as it pushes forward into the wind. 🔙
- **Literal Meaning:** As the engine works harder to climb the uphill slope, it releases a massive amount of white exhaust from its funnel. Because the train is moving forward and the wind is blowing, this steam is pushed backward, trailing behind the engine. The word "shovelling" makes the steam seem heavy and solid, like snow or coal. It is a physical sign of the intense heat and energy being used by the fire inside the locomotive to pull the heavy load of mail across the mountains. 🚂💨
- **Imagery:** A dramatic visual of thick white steam against a pitch-black night sky. It looks like a long, flowing white cape trailing behind the train. By saying "over her shoulder," Auden makes the train look like a laborer carrying a heavy sack or an athlete running a race. 🏃🦾
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the physical labor and effort required to serve the community. 🔥

Line 9: Snorting noisily as she passes

- **Phrase 1: "Snorting noisily"** – The loud, explosive puffing sound of the engine's exhaust. 🔊
- **Phrase 2: "as she passes"** – During the brief moment the train rushes past an observer. 🦾
- **Literal Meaning:** The train is making a very loud, aggressive noise as it travels through the quiet fields. This "snorting" is the mechanical sound of the steam being forced out of the engine's valves under high pressure. In the middle of the silent night, this sound is very powerful and can be

heard for miles. It announces to the world that the Night Mail is coming. The train does not move quietly; it moves with a loud, confident sound of industrial power and life. 🚂🦁

- **Imagery:** Animal imagery. Auden is comparing the train to a powerful horse or a bull "snorting" as it charges forward. This makes the metal machine feel like a living, breathing creature with a heart of fire. It gives the train a personality of strength and spirit. 🐾🔥
- **Deep Meaning:** Focuses on the vitality, energy, and "breath" of industrial power. ⚡

Line 10: Silent miles of wind-bent grasses.

- **Phrase 1: "Silent miles"** – Enormous distances where there is absolutely no sound or human life. 🤫🗺️
- **Phrase 2: "of wind-bent grasses"** – Grass that leans over because the wind never stops blowing. 🌾💨
- **Literal Meaning:** This line provides a massive contrast to the loud train in the previous line. While the train is snorting and puffing, everything around it for miles is completely silent. The only thing moving is the grass, which has been tilted sideways because the wind in the Scottish hills is so strong and constant. This emphasizes how lonely and desolate the journey is. The train is just a small, noisy spark of human activity in a giant, silent, and empty wilderness of nature. ⛰️🌫️
- **Imagery:** Creates a sense of desolation and scale. The "wind-bent grasses" suggest a cold, harsh environment where only the toughest plants survive. It paints a picture of a world dominated by the elements. The contrast between the noisy train and the lonely grass makes the train's mission seem even more heroic. 💨🌾
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the solitude and the vastness of the world that the mail must travel through. 🌫️🏞️

Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 11-24) 📖🚂

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Approaches	Comes nearer	The train getting closer to the animals. 🐓
Blank-faced	Expressionless / Empty	The coaches have no people looking out of the windows. 🚂
Slumber	Sleep	The peaceful sleep of the dogs. 😴
Freshens	Becomes cool and new	The arrival of the early morning air. 🌅
Descends	Moves downward	The train going down the hill toward the city. 📉
Steam-tugs	Small, powerful boats	Boats in the harbor that move larger ships. 🚢
Yelping	Sharp, high-pitched noise	The "barking" sound of the boat whistles. 🔊
Glade	An open space in a forest	Used here to describe a row of tall cranes. 🏗️

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Apparatus	Complex machinery	The technical equipment of the factories. ⚙️
Furnaces	Large industrial ovens	Huge structures used for melting metal or heating. 🔥
Chessmen	Pieces of a chess game	The factories looking like giant game pieces. ♟️
Glens	Narrow valleys	Deep, secluded valleys in the Scottish hills. 🏞️
Lochs	Scottish lakes	The beautiful, calm lakes of Scotland. 🌊

Line-by-Line Breakdown (Lines 11-24) 🧩✉️

Line 11: Birds turn their heads as she approaches,

- **Phrase 1: "Birds turn their heads"** – Small wild animals reacting to the sudden movement of the train. 🐓
- **Phrase 2: "as she approaches"** – At the moment the train comes closer into their view.
- **Literal Meaning:** As the heavy mail train enters the wild territory where the birds are resting, they physically move their heads to follow its progress. In the absolute silence of the moorland night, the train is the only source of light and sound. The birds are not flying away in fear; they are simply observing this massive intruder. It shows that even in the most

remote areas, the "Night Mail" is noticed by the natural world as it passes through. 🌳🦉

- **Imagery:** A picture of small, alert birds perched on branches or in the grass, their eyes reflecting the glowing lights of the engine as it thunders past them. It creates a sense of nature being a silent witness to human technology. 🌌👁️
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the intersection between the natural world and industrial progress. 🍃

Line 12: Stare from bushes at her blank-faced coaches.

- **Phrase 1: "Stare from bushes"** – Watching intently from a safe hiding place in the greenery. 👀
- **Phrase 2: "at her blank-faced coaches"** – Looking at the train cars that have no people or lights in the windows. 🚂🚫
- **Literal Meaning:** The birds remain in the safety of their bushes and watch the train go by. Because this is a specialized mail train, there are no passengers sitting by the windows. This makes the sides of the coaches look "blank" or like a face with no features. The train does not look back at the birds; it is focused entirely on its own destination. The birds are watching a giant, empty-looking machine that carries nothing but paper and secrets. 🏢🌑
- **Imagery:** The "blank-faced" coaches create a slightly eerie or mysterious image. It emphasizes that this is a "work" train, not a "travel" train. The contrast between the living, staring eyes of the birds and the dead, empty windows of the coaches is very strong. 🦉🏞️
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the impersonal and mechanical nature of the postal service. 🤖

Line 13 & 14: Sheep-dogs cannot turn her course; They slumber on with paws across.

- **Phrase 1: "Sheep-dogs cannot turn her course"** – The dogs that usually control sheep cannot stop or direct the train. 🐕🚫
- **Phrase 2: "They slumber on"** – They continue to sleep deeply and peacefully. 😴
- **Phrase 3: "with paws across"** – A comfortable, relaxed sleeping position.
- **Literal Meaning:** The sheep-dogs on the farms are used to chasing and controlling animals that move, but they have learned that they have no power over the "Night Mail." They don't even bother to wake up or bark at it anymore. The train passes by at the same time every night, so it has become a predictable part of their lives. The dogs stay in a deep sleep, completely undisturbed by the loud noise and vibration of the engine. 🐾🏡
- **Imagery:** A very peaceful image of a dog sleeping with its paws crossed over its chest, completely relaxed while a giant, snorting steam engine rushes past just a few yards away. It shows a perfect sense of routine and habit. 🐕💤
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows how technology has become a natural, accepted part of the environment. ✅

Line 15: In the farm she passes no one wakes,

- **Phrase 1: "In the farm she passes"** – Moving through the quiet agricultural areas. 🏘️
- **Phrase 2: "no one wakes"** – The human inhabitants stay in a deep sleep.
- **Literal Meaning:** As the train thunders past the farmhouses, none of the people sleeping inside are disturbed. The noise of the train has been repeating for so many years that it has become like a "lullaby" or background noise to them. The people are tired from their day's work and trust the schedule of the train so much that they don't even open an eye as it passes their windows. 😴🏠

- **Imagery:** A dark, quiet farmhouse standing still under the stars while the glowing train rushes by. It creates a feeling of safety and deep rest for the humans. 🌌🏠
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the harmony between the industrial schedule and the human sleep cycle. 🌙

Line 16: But a jug in a bedroom gently shakes.

- **Phrase 1: "But a jug in a bedroom"** – A small piece of pottery sitting on a table. 🏺
- **Phrase 2: "gently shakes"** – Vibrating slightly because of the train's power. 😳
- **Literal Meaning:** Although the people do not wake up, the physical power of the train is still felt. The heavy weight of the locomotive vibrating against the earth causes the ground to shake. Inside the nearby house, this vibration causes a water jug sitting on a nightstand to rattle or shake slightly. This is the only "reaction" the house has to the massive machine passing by. It is a tiny, delicate sign of the train's immense industrial strength. 🏠💧
- **Imagery:** An intimate, close-up image of a ceramic jug on a wooden table, with the water inside rippling slightly as the train roars past. It is a very quiet way to show "loud" power. 🏺✨
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows the subtle but undeniable impact of technology on our private lives. ⚡

Line 17: Dawn freshens, Her climb is done.

- **Phrase 1: "Dawn freshens"** – The early morning light is appearing, making the air feel cool and new. 🌅
- **Phrase 2: "Her climb is done"** – The difficult uphill journey over the mountains is finally finished. ✅

- **Literal Meaning:** The time has shifted from late night to early morning. The "freshness" of dawn suggests that the air is becoming clearer and the sun is about to rise. At this exact moment, the train has also finished its most difficult task: reaching the top of the steep hills. The struggle of the night is over, and the train is now on high ground, ready for an easier journey ahead. 🌄🚂
- **Imagery:** A beautiful sky changing from black to deep blue or orange. The steam from the train looks brighter in the morning light. It feels like a moment of relief and victory for the engine. 🌤️⛰️
- **Deep Meaning:** Symbolizes the end of a period of struggle and the arrival of a new beginning. 🏆

Line 18: Down towards Glasgow she descends,

- **Phrase 1: "Down towards Glasgow"** – Heading in the direction of Scotland's largest industrial city. 🏙️
- **Phrase 2: "she descends"** – Moving easily down the slope of the hill. 📉
- **Literal Meaning:** After reaching the summit, the train is now using gravity to help it move. It is gliding downward at a faster speed, heading directly toward the major city of Glasgow. This part of the journey is much easier and faster than the climb. The train is leaving the empty moors and moving toward the crowded, busy world of factories and ships. 🚂🏭
- **Imagery:** The train picking up speed as it goes downhill, with the distant lights of a big city appearing on the horizon. It is an image of "momentum" and energy. 🚀🏙️
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the smooth progress toward a goal after a difficult challenge. ✅

Line 19: Towards the steam-tugs yelping down a glade of cranes

- **Phrase 1: "Towards the steam-tugs yelping"** – Moving to the harbor where small boats make sharp, barking sounds. 🚢📢

- **Phrase 2: "down a glade of cranes"** – Passing through a long row of tall lifting machines. 🏗️
- **Literal Meaning:** The train is entering the industrial port area of Glasgow. Here, small "tug-boats" are moving through the water, making high-pitched whistling noises that sound like dogs "yelping." The train passes between rows of tall, thin cranes used for loading ships. Auden uses the word "glade" (which usually means a path in a forest) to describe the path made by these giant metal machines. 🚢🏗️
- **Imagery:** An "industrial forest." Instead of trees, there are tall cranes; instead of birds, there are whistling boats. It is a vivid picture of a world made of steel and steam. 🏭⚙️
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows how industry has created its own version of a "natural" landscape. 🏗️🌳

Line 20 & 21: Towards the fields of apparatus, the furnaces / Set on the dark plain like gigantic chessmen.

- **Phrase 1: "Towards the fields of apparatus"** – Moving through vast areas filled with machinery and technical equipment. ⚙️
- **Phrase 2: "the furnaces"** – Passing large, hot industrial ovens. 🔥
- **Phrase 3: "Set on the dark plain like gigantic chessmen"** – Looking like massive pieces of a chess game on a flat board. ♟️
- **Literal Meaning:** The train travels through the "Black Country" or the heavy industrial zones. There are huge fields filled with complicated machines and smoking furnaces used for making steel. These massive buildings are spread out across a flat, dark area. From the train's perspective, they look like giant Kings, Queens, and Knights sitting on a huge chessboard, waiting for a game to be played. 🏭♟️
- **Imagery:** One of the most famous similes in poetry. The dark ground is the "board," and the smoking factories are the "pieces." It makes the huge, scary factories look organized and intentional, as if a giant were playing a game with the city. 🌑♟️

- **Deep Meaning:** Suggests that the industrial world is a complex, strategic "game" managed by invisible forces. 🧠⚙️

Line 22: All Scotland waits for her:

- **Phrase 1: "All Scotland waits"** – The entire nation is in a state of anticipation. 🏴□□□□□□⏳
- **Phrase 2: "for her"** – Specifically waiting for the arrival of the Night Mail train.
- **Literal Meaning:** The importance of the train is finally revealed. It isn't just a machine moving through the night; it is the most expected visitor in the country. From the southern borders to the northern islands, everyone is waiting for the news, money, and letters that only this train can bring. The whole country feels incomplete until the train arrives. ✉️🤝
- **Imagery:** A nation-wide feeling of "holding one's breath." It creates a sense of the train being a celebrity or a hero that everyone is looking for. 🌍🏅
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the dependency of a society on its systems of communication. 🔗

Line 23 & 24: In the dark glens, beside the pale-green lochs / Men long for news.

- **Phrase 1: "In the dark glens"** – Inside the deep, shadowy valleys of the mountains. 🌰
- **Phrase 2: "beside the pale-green lochs"** – Next to the calm, light-colored Scottish lakes. 🌊
- **Phrase 3: "Men long for news"** – People have a deep, emotional desire to hear from others. 📰🙏
- **Literal Meaning:** Even in the most beautiful and remote parts of Scotland—the deep valleys and the quiet lakesides—people are feeling

lonely. They are waiting for the "Night Mail" to bring them letters from friends, family, or the government. No matter how peaceful their environment is, they still have a "longing" (a strong hunger) for connection with the rest of the world. ✉️⛰️

- **Imagery:** A lonely man standing by a quiet, misty lake in the early morning, looking down the road for the postman. It is a scene of quiet hope and solitude. 🌫️🌊
- **Deep Meaning:** Emphasizes the fundamental human need to be remembered and connected to others. 💔📬

Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 25-43) 📖✉️

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Receipted	Marked as paid	Bills that have been settled and confirmed. 🧾
Situations	Jobs / Employment	People writing letters to apply for work. 💼
Timid	Shy / Nervous	Lovers who are too scared to speak in person. 😳
Declarations	Statements of feelings	Openly confessing love or intentions. ❤️
Circumstantial	Detailed / Specific	News about daily events or specific situations. 📝

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Snaps	Photographs	Casual photos taken during a vacation. 📸
Scrawled	Written messily	Drawings or notes made quickly in the corners. ✍️
Condolence	Sympathy for loss	Letters sent to people who are grieving. 🕊️
Hue	Color / Shade	The different colors of stationery paper used. 🎨
Catty	Mean / Spiteful	Gossip that is intended to be a bit rude or sharp. 😾

Line-by-Line Breakdown (Lines 25-43) 🧩🚂

Line 25: Letters of thanks, letters from banks,

- **Phrase 1: "Letters of thanks"** – Notes expressing gratitude for gifts or help. 🙏
- **Phrase 2: "letters from banks"** – Formal financial statements or business notices. 🏦
- **Literal Meaning:** The train is carrying a huge variety of mail that covers the entire spectrum of human life. It holds polite "thank you" notes sent between friends or family members for various kindnesses. At the same time, it carries the cold, official correspondence from banking institutions regarding loans, savings, or debts. This shows that the train

handles both the warm, emotional side of life and the dry, serious side of money management at the same time. ✉️📈

- **Imagery:** An image of two very different envelopes: one perhaps handwritten and small, the other a formal, windowed envelope with a bank's logo. 📩
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows that the postal service supports both our emotional and practical needs. ⚖️

Line 26: Letters of joy from girl and boy,

- **Phrase 1: "Letters of joy"** – Messages filled with happiness and celebration. 🎉
- **Phrase 2: "from girl and boy"** – Written by children or young people. 👧👦
- **Literal Meaning:** The mailbags are packed with the excitement of youth. These are letters written by children or young adults sharing happy news, such as winning a game, doing well in school, or simply saying hello. These letters are full of positive energy and represent the "joy" that travels across the country on the tracks. It reminds us that the train is a messenger of happiness for the younger generation, connecting them to their friends and relatives. 💌✨
- **Imagery:** Colorful, perhaps messy handwriting on paper, smelling of childhood excitement. It creates a "bright" image amidst the dark night journey of the train. 🎨
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the role of the post in sharing human happiness. 😊

Line 27 & 28: Receipted bills and invitations / To inspect new stock or to visit relations,

- **Phrase 1: "Receipted bills"** – Proof that a debt has been paid. ✅
- **Phrase 2: "and invitations"** – Requests to attend an event. ✉️

- **Phrase 3: "To inspect new stock"** – Business invites to see new products. 📦
- **Phrase 4: "or to visit relations"** – Family invites to come and stay. 🏠
- **Literal Meaning:** The train carries the boring but necessary parts of life, like confirmed bills that show a person has paid their electricity or rent. It also carries exciting invitations. Some are for business purposes, like a shop inviting customers to see their new winter clothes or tools. Others are personal, like a grandmother asking her grandchildren to come for a visit. The train is the link that facilitates both the "work" of the economy and the "pleasure" of family life. 🏡🤝
- **Imagery:** A pile of mail containing a stiff, formal invitation card next to a thin, stamped bill. It shows the busy, organized nature of society. 🏛️
- **Deep Meaning:** Connects the world of commerce with the world of family. 🔗

Line 29: And applications for situations,

- **Phrase 1: "And applications"** – Formal requests to be considered for something. 📝
- **Phrase 2: "for situations"** – For jobs or employment positions. 💼
- **Literal Meaning:** This is one of the most important types of mail the train carries. It holds the "applications" of people who are desperately looking for work. These are letters filled with hope and anxiety, sent by individuals who want to improve their lives. In the 1930s, the mail was the only way to apply for a job in another city. The Night Mail carries the futures of these workers in its bags, moving their dreams toward the desks of bosses in Glasgow or Edinburgh. 🛠️🙏
- **Imagery:** A thick, carefully written letter with a CV inside, representing a person's hope for a better future. 📄
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the train as a vehicle for human ambition and survival. 🚀

Line 30: And timid lovers' declarations,

- **Phrase 1: "And timid lovers'"** – People who are shy about their feelings. 😳
- **Phrase 2: "declarations"** – Openly stating their love in writing. ❤️
- **Literal Meaning:** The train is a secret-keeper for the heart. It carries letters from people who are too shy or "timid" to say "I love you" to someone's face. Instead, they write their feelings down on paper and trust the Night Mail to deliver their heart's confession. These letters are filled with soft emotions and are perhaps the most precious items on the train. The mail allows love to travel through the dark across hundreds of miles. 💌🌹
- **Imagery:** A letter sealed with a kiss or written in very neat, careful ink, held by a nervous hand. It adds a "romantic" layer to the mechanical train. 💏
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows the post as a safe space for vulnerable human emotions. 💞

Line 31: And gossip, gossip from all the nations,

- **Phrase 1: "And gossip, gossip"** – Casual talk or rumors about other people. 🗣️
- **Phrase 2: "from all the nations"** – Coming from many different places and cultures. 🌍
- **Literal Meaning:** Not all mail is serious or romantic; a lot of it is just "gossip." These are the chatty letters where people share news about who is getting married, who is moving away, or what happened at a party. Because the Night Mail connects so many places, it brings together stories from all over the country. The repetition of the word "gossip" makes it sound like the "chatter" of the nation is filling the train cars as they rush through the night. 🤫🗨️

- **Imagery:** The sound of many voices whispering together. It creates a "noisy" mental image inside the silent train, filled with the secrets of a million people. 👥
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the social fabric and curiosity that binds a nation together. 🧶

Line 32: News circumstantial, news financial,

- **Phrase 1: "News circumstantial"** – General news about daily life and events. 📰
- **Phrase 2: "news financial"** – Specific news about money, stocks, and business. 💹
- **Literal Meaning:** The train carries two main types of information. "Circumstantial" news includes letters about how the weather is, how someone's health is, or small details about a local event. "Financial" news is much more technical, dealing with stock market reports, bank interest rates, and business profits. The train ensures that the "brain" of the country (the financial world) and the "body" of the country (regular life) both stay informed. 🏛️📈
- **Imagery:** A newspaper-style report mixed with a handwritten letter. It shows the balance between "hard" data and "soft" personal stories. 📊
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the train as a carrier of both logic and life. 🧠

Line 33: Letters with holiday snaps to enlarge in,

- **Phrase 1: "Letters with holiday snaps"** – Photos taken on vacation. 📸
- **Phrase 2: "to enlarge in"** – To be sent to a shop to be made into bigger prints. 🖼️
- **Literal Meaning:** In the 1930s, people had to mail their film or "snaps" to professional labs to have them developed or "enlarged." This line shows the train carrying the happy memories of people who have been to the beach or the mountains. These letters contain the visual history of

families, captured in small black-and-white photos, traveling to be turned into beautiful keepsakes. 🏖️🎞️

- **Imagery:** Small, glossy photographs of a family at the seaside, tucked inside an envelope. It adds a "visual" and "memory-based" element to the mail. 🌊
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the preservation of human memories and happy times. ⏳

Line 34: Letters with faces scrawled on the margin,

- **Phrase 1: "Letters with faces"** – Small drawings of people. 😊
- **Phrase 2: "scrawled on the margin"** – Sketched quickly in the white space at the edge of the paper. ✍️
- **Literal Meaning:** This refers to the very personal touches people add to their letters. Someone might be writing a long message and decide to draw a quick "smiley face" or a little portrait of themselves in the margin (the edge) of the paper. These "scrawls" are not professional art; they are messy, quick, and full of personality. They show the playfulness of the writers and make the mail feel even more intimate and alive. 📝🎨
- **Imagery:** A handwritten page with a little cartoon doodle in the corner. It is a very "human" and "cute" image that shows the personality of the writer. 🖍️
- **Deep Meaning:** Focuses on the unique, individual identity behind every piece of mail. 👤

Line 35: Letters from uncles, cousins, and aunts,

- **Phrase 1: "Letters from uncles, cousins, and aunts"** – Correspondence between extended family members. 👨‍👩‍👧‍👦
- **Literal Meaning:** The train is the glue that keeps the "extended family" together. In an era before telephones were common, letters were the only way for uncles, aunts, and cousins living in different cities to stay in

touch. The Night Mail carries the family history—births, deaths, and holiday plans—ensuring that even if a family is spread across the entire country, they still feel like they belong to one another. 🔗🏠

- **Imagery:** A huge tree of connections, with the train tracks acting as the "branches" that reach every relative. It creates a feeling of "belonging." 🌳
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the preservation of the family unit across distances. ❤️‍🩹

Line 36: Letters to Scotland from the South of France,

- **Phrase 1: "Letters to Scotland"** – The destination of the mail. 🏴□□□□□□
- **Phrase 2: "from the South of France"** – The exotic, warm origin of the mail. FR🌻
- **Literal Meaning:** This line shows the "International" reach of the postal system. Someone is on a luxury vacation in the sunny South of France and is writing to their friend or family in the cold, rainy hills of Scotland. The Night Mail is the final leg of this long journey, carrying a "piece of sunshine" (the letter) from the Mediterranean to the North. It highlights how the train connects the small local world to the vast, exciting world of travel. 🗺️✈️
- **Imagery:** A bright, colorful postcard with a French stamp sitting in a dark mailbag on a cold Scottish train. It is a contrast between "warmth" and "cold." 🌻❄️
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows how the post collapses geographical distances and brings the world together. 🌍

Line 37: Letters of condolence to Highlands and Lowlands

- **Phrase 1: "Letters of condolence"** – Messages of sympathy for someone who has died. 🕊️💭

- **Phrase 2: "to Highlands and Lowlands"** – To every part of Scotland, from the mountains to the plains. 🏔️🏞️
- **Literal Meaning:** The train also carries the "heavy" mail of sadness. "Condolence" letters are sent to people who are grieving a loss. The train carries these messages of support to every corner of Scotland—the rugged "Highlands" and the industrial "Lowlands." It shows that the post is there for the most difficult moments of life, ensuring that no one has to suffer through grief without hearing a kind word from a friend. 🖤🕯️
- **Imagery:** A black-edged envelope (common for mourning in the past) traveling through the misty morning. It is a very solemn and respectful image. ✉️
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the train as a bearer of human empathy and support. 🤝

  Line: Notes from overseas to Hebrides

- **Phrase 1: "Notes from overseas"** – Letters and short messages that have traveled from international locations across the world. 🌏✈️
- **Phrase 2: "to Hebrides"** – The destination is the group of rocky, remote islands off the coast of Scotland. 🏴🏝️
- **Literal Meaning:** This line demonstrates the massive, global scale of the postal network. The Night Mail is the final link in a chain that starts in far-off foreign countries (overseas). A person might write a letter in a place like India, America, or Australia, and after it crosses the great oceans, the Night Mail carries it through the Scottish mountains to reach the **Hebrides**.

Line 38 & 39: Written on paper of every hue, / The pink, the violet, the white and the blue,

- **Phrase 1: "Written on paper of every hue"** – Using stationery of every possible color. 🎨
- **Phrase 2: "The pink, the violet, the white and the blue"** – Listing specific colors. 🌸🍇☁️🌊

- **Literal Meaning:** This section describes the physical appearance of the mail. People don't just use plain white paper; they use "pink" for love letters, "violet" or "blue" for fancy stationery, and "white" for business. This "rainbow" of paper inside the mailbags represents the diversity of human emotions and topics. The train is filled with a literal "explosion of color" that represents the vibrant lives of the people who wrote the letters. 🌈📝
- **Imagery:** A mailbag being opened and a cascade of different colored envelopes spilling out. It is a very "vivid" and "pretty" image that contrasts with the black engine of the train. 🎨✨
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the variety and richness of human experience. 🎭

Line 40: The chatty, the catty, the boring, the adoring,

- **Phrase 1: "The chatty"** – Friendly and long-winded letters. 🗣️
- **Phrase 2: "the catty"** – Mean or spiteful letters filled with insults. 😾
- **Phrase 3: "the boring"** – Dull letters about nothing important. 😴
- **Phrase 4: "the adoring"** – Letters filled with deep love and worship. 😍
- **Literal Meaning:** Auden is describing the "personality" of the letters. Some are "chatty" (full of friendly talk), while others are "catty" (filled with mean gossip or "spite"). Some are "boring" (just lists of chores or dull news), and others are "adoring" (passionate love letters). This list shows that the train carries every possible human attitude—from the kindest to the meanest. It is a complete record of how humans feel and speak to one another. 🎭📜
- **Imagery:** A series of different "voices" coming from the mailbags. It's like a crowd of people talking all at once, each with a different tone of voice. 🗣️👂
- **Deep Meaning:** Reflects the complexity and flaws of human nature. ☯️

Line 41: The cold and official and the heart's outpouring,

- **Phrase 1: "The cold and official"** – Harsh, formal letters from the government or law. 🏢❄️
- **Phrase 2: "and the heart's outpouring"** – Deeply emotional, honest confessions of feeling. ❤️🌊
- **Literal Meaning:** This line presents the ultimate contrast. The "cold and official" letters are the ones that are typed, formal, and often bring bad news (like a tax bill or a legal notice). In the very same mailbag is "the heart's outpouring"—a letter where someone has poured out their deepest soul, crying or laughing onto the page. The train carries the most "robotic" and the most "human" parts of life side-by-side. 🤖💖
- **Imagery:** A stamped government document sitting right on top of a tear-stained love letter. It is a powerful image of life's contradictions. ⚖️
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows that the post office is a neutral container for all of life's extremes. 🏛️

Line 42: Clever, stupid, short and long,

- **Phrase 1: "Clever, stupid"** – Letters that are smart and witty, and those that are simple or poorly thought out. 🧠🤡
- **Phrase 2: "short and long"** – Quick postcards and giant, multi-page letters. 📝long-scroll
- **Literal Meaning:** This line focuses on the "quality" and "size" of the messages. Some writers are "clever" and use fancy words and jokes; others are "stupid" or simple and just say the basics. Some people write "short" notes because they are busy, while others write "long" letters that go on for pages. The train doesn't judge; it carries the 5-word postcard and the 10-page letter with the same dedication. 🖋️✉️
- **Imagery:** A tiny postcard with just "Miss you!" written on it, next to a heavy, thick envelope that is bursting at the seams. It shows the variety of effort people put into connection. 📮

- **Deep Meaning:** Celebrates the diversity of human intelligence and effort. 🌈

Line 43: The typed and the printed and the spelt all wrong.

- **Phrase 1: "The typed and the printed"** – Professional business mail made by machines. ⌨️🖨️
- **Phrase 2: "and the spelt all wrong"** – Letters with many spelling mistakes. ❌✍️
- **Literal Meaning:** This final line of the section describes the "accuracy" of the mail. It includes "typed" business letters and "printed" advertisements that look perfect. But it also includes the "spelt all wrong" letters—perhaps from a child learning to write, an uneducated worker, or someone writing in a great hurry. These "wrong" letters are often the most "real" and touching. The train is a service that doesn't care about your education; it just cares about delivering your voice. 🏫🤝
- **Imagery:** A perfectly typed business letter with a formal header, contrasted with a child's letter where "Mother" is spelled "Muvver." It is a very sweet and human image. 👶📝
- **Deep Meaning:** Emphasizes that the desire to connect is more important than being "perfect." ❤️‍🩹✅

Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 44-53) 📖🥳

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Cranston's / Crawford's	Famous tea rooms	Real popular cafes in 1930s Scotland. ☕

Word	Simple Meaning	Context in the Poem
Well-set	Well-established / Wealthy	Describing the organized and rich city of Edinburgh. 🏛️
Granite	A hard, grey rock	Aberdeen is known as the "Granite City" because of its buildings. 🏢
Quickening	Speeding up / Beating faster	The heart beating faster due to excitement or anxiety. ❤️‍📈
Bear	To tolerate / Endure	The difficulty of handling the feeling of being lonely. 😟

Detailed Analysis (Lines 44-53) 🧩💤

Line 44: Thousands are still asleep,

- **Phrase 1: "Thousands are still asleep"** – The vast majority of the population is still in bed. 😴👥
- **Literal Meaning:** As the Night Mail train approaches its final stops in the early morning, the millions of people living in the great cities and small towns of Scotland are still unconscious and resting. They have no idea that the train has spent the entire night fighting through mountains and wind to bring them their mail. The world is quiet and still, creating a massive contrast between the "active" train and the "passive" people who are about to receive its gifts. 🌌🌙
- **Imagery:** An image of a dark, silent city with thousands of windows, behind which people are tucked under blankets. It emphasizes the peace of the morning before the busy day begins. 🏠✨

- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the quiet vulnerability of humanity before the start of a new day. ⏳

Line 45: Dreaming of terrifying monsters

- **Phrase 1: "Dreaming of terrifying monsters"** – People having nightmares or scary thoughts. 👹 💭
- **Literal Meaning:** Auden explores the private minds of the sleeping people. Some of them are having bad dreams or nightmares about scary creatures. This shows that while their bodies are still, their minds are very active and sometimes troubled. It adds a touch of "darkness" to the poem, showing that even in sleep, humans have fears and anxieties. The train carries the letters that might solve these fears or bring new ones. 🧠 🌑
- **Imagery:** Dark, distorted shapes in a dream. It creates a psychological image of the "inner world" of the people the train is serving. 🎭
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the internal struggles and fears that everyone shares. 🌩️

Line 46: Or of friendly tea beside the band in Cranston's or Crawford's:

- **Phrase 1: "Or of friendly tea"** – Dreaming of social, happy times. ☕ 🍰
- **Phrase 2: "beside the band"** – Listening to live music while eating. 🎷
- **Phrase 3: "in Cranston's or Crawford's"** – In the famous, elegant tea rooms of the time. 🏛️
- **Literal Meaning:** In contrast to the nightmares, other people are having very pleasant, cozy dreams. They are imagining themselves sitting in the most famous and beautiful cafes of 1930s Scotland (Cranston's and Crawford's), drinking tea and listening to an orchestra play. It represents the "ideal" social life—warmth, music, and friendship. These are the happy memories and hopes of the Scottish people as they wait for the morning to come. 🧁 ✨

- **Imagery:** A bright, warm cafe filled with the smell of tea and the sound of violins. It is a very "civilized" and "comfortable" image that contrasts with the cold, industrial steel of the train. 🎻🍰
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the human desire for comfort, peace, and social belonging. 💖

Line 47 & 48: Asleep in working Glasgow, asleep in well-set Edinburgh, / Asleep in granite Aberdeen,

- **Phrase 1: "Asleep in working Glasgow"** – The people in the busy, industrial city are resting. 🏭
- **Phrase 2: "asleep in well-set Edinburgh"** – The people in the grand, historic capital are resting. 🏰
- **Phrase 3: "Asleep in granite Aberdeen"** – The people in the cold, gray northern city are resting. 🏢
- **Literal Meaning:** Auden lists the three major cities of Scotland to show that the Night Mail serves the entire nation. Glasgow is "working" because it is a city of factories and ships. Edinburgh is "well-set" because it is the wealthy city of law and history. Aberdeen is "granite" because its buildings are made of hard, sparkling gray stone. No matter the type of city—industrial, wealthy, or cold—everyone is united in the same state of sleep, waiting for the same train. 🏴□□□□□□🗺️
- **Imagery:** A map of Scotland where the lights of the big cities are slowly fading as dawn approaches. The "granite" of Aberdeen and the "smoke" of Glasgow provide a strong sense of place and texture. 🧱🌫️
- **Deep Meaning:** Shows that despite our different jobs or status, we are all equal in our basic human needs. ⚖️

Line 49: They continue their dreams,

- **Phrase 1: "They continue their dreams"** – They are still deep in their unconscious thoughts. 💤

- **Literal Meaning:** For a few more minutes, the people are allowed to stay in their private worlds of imagination. They don't know that the Night Mail has arrived in the city and that the postmen are already starting to sort the letters. This is the final moment of peace before the "real world" of bills, news, and work begins. The dreams are the last shield between the person and the responsibilities of the day. ⏳💭
- **Imagery:** A soft, lingering image of someone turning over in their sleep, unaware that a letter is about to change their day. 🛌
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the thin line between our private fantasies and public reality. 🌈

Line 50: But shall wake soon and hope for letters,

- **Phrase 1: "But shall wake soon"** – The moment of waking up is coming. 🌅
- **Phrase 2: "and hope for letters"** – Their first thought will be about receiving mail. ✉️🙏
- **Literal Meaning:** As soon as the sun comes up and people open their eyes, their first instinct will be to check for mail. This "hope" is a universal feeling. Whether it is a businessman waiting for a cheque or a girl waiting for a love letter, the arrival of the post is the highlight of the morning. It shows that the work of the Night Mail train is the most important part of the start of a Scottish day. 🏠📬
- **Imagery:** A person sitting up in bed and looking toward the front door, waiting for the sound of the letterbox. It is an image of "anticipation." 👀✨
- **Deep Meaning:** Highlights the constant human craving for news and connection. 🔗

Line 51 & 52: And none will hear the postman's knock / Without a quickening of the heart,

- **Phrase 1: "And none will hear"** – Not a single person will experience this sound... 👂
- **Phrase 2: "the postman's knock"** – The literal sound of the mail being delivered. ✊🚪
- **Phrase 3: "Without a quickening of the heart"** – ...without their heart beating faster. ❤️📈
- **Literal Meaning:** Auden describes a feeling that everyone has experienced. When you hear the postman knock on your door or the sound of letters hitting the floor, your heart rate naturally increases. This is because every letter is a "surprise"—it could be good news, a gift, or a message from a long-lost friend. That tiny "thump" of the heart is the physical reaction to the possibility of being connected to the world. No one is too old or too serious to feel this excitement. 📮💓
- **Imagery:** The sharp, sudden sound of a knock on a wooden door echoing through a quiet house. It creates a "jolt" of energy in the poem. 📢🚪
- **Deep Meaning:** Represents the thrill and anxiety of the "unknown" that every message carries. 🎲

Line 53: For who can bear to feel himself forgotten?

- **Phrase 1: "For who can bear"** – Who can actually tolerate or survive... 😨
- **Phrase 2: "to feel himself forgotten?"** ...the cold, sad feeling that no one in the world is thinking about them?
- **Literal Meaning:** This is the final, most powerful line of the poem. Auden asks a rhetorical question: who is strong enough to live with the feeling that they have been forgotten by the world? A letter is proof that someone, somewhere, was thinking about you. Receiving mail means you still exist in someone else's mind. The "Night Mail" train travels through storms and mountains just to prevent people from feeling this terrible loneliness. The train isn't just delivering paper; it is delivering the "proof of love" and "proof of existence." ✉️💎

- **Literal Meaning (Summary):** The entire journey of the train, the snorting engine, and the climb over the moors were all done to satisfy this one deep human need: **the need to be remembered.**
- **Deep Meaning:** The ultimate message of the poem—human connection is what makes life worth living, and technology is the tool that keeps us from being lonely. 💔🌍🤝

FIGURES OF SPEECH

- Line 1: This is the night mail crossing the Border, — **Personification** 🚂
- Line 2: Bringing the cheque and the postal order, — **Metonymy** 💸
- Line 3: Letters for the rich, letters for the poor, — **Anaphora / Repetition** ⚖️
- Line 4: The shop at the corner, the girl next door. — **Synecdoche** 🏘️
- Line 5: Pulling up Beattock, a steady climb: — **Personification** 🧗
- Line 6: The gradient's against her, but she's on time. — **Personification** ⏱️
- Line 7: Past cotton-grass and moorland boulder — **Alliteration** 🌾
- Line 8: Shovelling white steam over her shoulder, — **Metaphor / Personification** ☁️
- Line 9: Snorting noisily as she passes — **Onomatopoeia / Personification** 😤
- Line 10: Silent miles of wind-bent grasses. — **Sibilance / Alliteration** 😶
- Line 11: Birds turn their heads as she approaches, — **Personification** 🐦
- Line 12: Stare from bushes at her blank-faced coaches. — **Transferred Epithet** 🚃
- Line 13: Sheep-dogs cannot turn her course; — **Personification** 🐕
- Line 14: They slumber on with paws across. — **Alliteration** 😴
- Line 15: In the farm she passes no one wakes, — **Personification** 🏠
- Line 16: But a jug in a bedroom gently shakes. — **Imagery** 🏺
- Line 17: Dawn freshens, Her climb is done. — **Personification** 🌅
- Line 18: Down towards Glasgow she descends, — **Alliteration** 🗺️
- Line 19: Towards the steam tugs yelping down a glade of cranes — **Onomatopoeia / Metaphor** 🏗️
- Line 21: Set on the dark plain like gigantic chessmen. — **Simile** ♟️
- Line 22: All Scotland waits for her: — **Hyperbole / Personification** 🏴□□□□□□
- Line 23: In dark glens, beside pale-green lochs — **Imagery** 🌊
- Line 24: Men long for news. — **Personification** 📰
- Line 25: Letters of thanks, letters from banks, — **Internal Rhyme** 🏦

- Line 26: Letters of joy from girl and boy, — **Internal Rhyme** 👧
- Line 27: Receipted bills and invitations — **Alliteration** 📜
- Line 31: And gossip, gossip from all the nations, — **Epizeuxis (Repetition)** 🗣️
- Line 38: Written on paper of every hue, — **Assonance** 🎨
- Line 39: The pink, the violet, the white and the blue, — **Polysyndeton** 🌈
- Line 40: The chatty, the catty, the boring, the adoring, — **Antithesis / Internal Rhyme** 🎭
- Line 41: The cold and official and the heart's outpouring, — **Antithesis** ⚖️
- Line 42: Clever, stupid, short and long, — **Antithesis** 📏
- Line 43: The typed and the printed and the spelt all wrong. — **Polysyndeton** ❌
- Line 51: And none will hear the postman's knock — **Onomatopoeia** 🚪
- Line 52: Without a quickening of the heart, — **Metaphor** 💗
- Line 53: For who can bear to feel himself forgotten? — **Rhetorical Question** 💎